

0.0.1 Assemblies

1. There are, O bhikkhus, these two assemblies. Which two? The assembly trained in empty talk, not in counter-questioning, and the assembly trained in counter-questioning, not in empty talk.

2. And which, O bhikkhus, is the assembly trained in empty talk, not in counter-questioning? “Here, O bhikkhus, in this assembly, when the discourses spoken by the Tathagata that are deep, deep in meaning, supramundane, connected with voidness, are being expounded, the bhikkhus do not listen. They do not give ear attentively. They do not apply their minds to understand it. They think those dhammas should not be learned and mastered. However, when discourses spoken by poets, elegant in sound, elegant in phrasing, [composed

parisāsuttam

dvemā bhikkhave parisā. katamā dve: okkācitavinītā¹ parisā no paṭipucchāvinītā, paṭipucchāvinītā parisā no okkācitavinītā.

katamā ca bhikkhave okkācitavinītā parisā no paṭipucchāvinītā: idha bhikkhave yassaṃ parisāyaṃ bhikkhū ye te suttantā tathāgatabhāsītā gambhīrā gambhīratthā lokutarā suññatā² paṭisaññuttā. tesu bhaññamānesu na sussūsanti na sotam odahanti, na aññācittam upaṭṭhapenti, na ca te dhamme uggahe-tabbam pariyāpuṇi-

¹ukkācīkavinītā - simu, sīl, pts, syā

²suññātapaṭisaṃyuttā - syā

by] outsiders, spoken by disciples, are being expounded, the bhikkhus do listen. They give ear attentively. They apply their minds to understand it. They think those dhammas should be learned and mastered. They, having mastered that dhamma, do not examine and cross-question each other [asking]: “How is this? What is the meaning of this?” They do not disclose the undisclosed, do not explain the unexplained, and they do not dispel their doubts in regard to the numerous perplexing dhammas. This, O bhikkhus, is called the assembly trained in empty talk, not in counter-questioning.”

tabbamaṃ maññanti. ye pana te suttantaṃ kavikata³ kaveyyā citta-kkharā citta-byañjanaṃ bāhira-kā sāvaka-bhāsitaṃ. tesu bhañña-mānesu susūsanti, sotamaṃ odahanti, añña-cittaṃ upaṭṭhapenti, te ca dhamme uggahe-tabbamaṃ pariyāpuṇitabbamaṃ maññanti. te taṃ dhammaṃ pariyāpuṇitvā na ceva añña-maññaṃ paṭipucchanti, paṭivacaranti⁴ idaṃ kathaṃ imassa kvatthoti? te avivaṭaṇceva na vivaranti, anuttānīka-taṇca no uttānī karonti. anekavihitesu ca kaṅkhaṭṭhānīyesu dhammesu kaṅkhaṃ na paṭivinodenti⁵.

³kavitā - machasaṃ

⁴pavivaranti - katthaci

⁵nappaṭivinodenti - machasaṃ, syā

3. And which, O bhikkhus, is the assembly trained in counter-questioning, not in empty talk? “Here, O bhikkhus, in this assembly, when discourses spoken by poets, elegant in sound, elegant in phrasing, [composed by] outsiders, spoken by disciples, are being expounded, the bhikkhus do not listen. They do not give ear attentively. They do not apply their minds to understand it. They think those dhammas should not be learned and mastered. However, when the discourses spoken by the Tathagata that are deep, deep in meaning, supramundane, connected with voidness, are being expounded, the bhikkhus do listen. They give ear attentively. They apply

ayaṃ vuccati bhikkhave okkācitavinītā parisā no paṭipucchāvinītā.

katamā ca bhikkhave paṭipucchāvinītā parisā no okkācitavinītā: idha bhikkhave yassaṃ parisāyaṃ bhikkhū ye te suttantā, kavikatā kāveyyā cittakkharā cittabyañjanā bāhirakā sāvakabhāsītā, tesu bhaññamānesu na sussūsanti, na sotam odahanti. na aññā cittam upaṭṭhapenti, na ca te dhamme uggahe-tabbam pariyāpuṇitabbam maññanti. ye pana te suttantā tathāgatabhāsītā gambhīratthā lokuttarā suññatā paṭisaññuttā, tesu bhaññamānesu sussūsanti, sotam

their minds to understand it. They think those dhammas should be learned and mastered. They, having mastered that dhamma, do examine and cross-question each other [asking]: “How is this? What is the meaning of this?” They disclose the undisclosed, explain the unexplained, and they dispel their doubts in regard to the numerous perplexing dhammas. This, O bhikkhus, is called the assembly trained in counter-questioning, not in empty talk.”

4. “Of these two assemblies, O bhikkhus, this is the highest, O bhikkhus, namely, the assembly trained in counter-questioning, not in empty talk.”

odahanti, aññā cit-
taṃ upaṭṭhapenti,
te ca dhamme ug-
gahetabbam pari-
yāpunitabbam mañ-
ñanti. te taṃ dham-
maṃ pariyāpunitvā
aññamaññaṃ paṭi-
pucchanti, paṭivica-
ranti, idaṃ kathaṃ?
imassa kvatthoti⁶,
te avivaṭaṇceva vi-
varanti? anuttānī-
kataṇca uttānīka-
ronti, anekavihitesu
ca kaṅkhāṭṭhānīyesu
dhammesu kaṅkhaṃ
paṭivinodenti. ayaṃ
vuccati bhikkhave
paṭipucchāvinītā pa-
risā no okkācitavi-
nītā.

imā kho bhikkhave
dve parisā etadag-
gaṃ bhikkhave imā-
saṃ dvinnam pari-
sānam yadidaṃ paṭi-

⁶ko atthoti - machasam

pucchāvinītā parisā
no okkācitavinītāti.

